

Meem Sakinah Rules

■ This is a study companion for your Tajweed course. Each bullet point is a key concept from the video lecture. Review these pointers before or after each lesson.

Meem Sakinah — Introduction

- Meem Sakinah = Meem (■) with sukoon: ■■
- When Meem Sakinah meets the next letter, one of 3 rules applies
- ALL 3 rules are called Shafawi (■■■■■■■■) = labial/lip rules
- Why? Because Meem (■) comes from the lips (shafa = lip)
- The rules are simpler than Noon Sakinah — only 3 instead of 4

Rule 1: Ikhfa Shafawi (Lip Concealment)

- TRIGGER: Meem Sakinah followed by Ba (■) only
- ACTION: Close lips lightly + hold Ghunnah for 2 beats + release into Ba
- The Meem is not fully pronounced but concealed with nasal resonance
- Unlike Iqlab, the Meem doesn't convert — it just conceals into itself
- Example: ■■■■■■■■■■ ■■■■■■■■■■ — the ■■ before ■■ → Ikhfa Shafawi
- Example: ■■■■ ■■■■■■■■■■ — ■■ before ■■ — lips close gently + nasal hold
- SIGN IN MUSHAF: A small circle above the Meem in some copies

Rule 2: Idgham Shafawi (Lip Merging)

- TRIGGER: Meem Sakinah followed by another Meem (■)
- ACTION: The two Meems merge into one elongated Meem with Ghunnah
- Hold the nasal Ghunnah for 2 beats — it's a full merge
- Example: ■■■■■■ ■■■ ■■■■■■■■■■ — ■■ before ■■ → lahum-maa (held nasal merge)
- Example: ■■■■■■■■ ■■■■■■■■■■ — same rule
- This creates a smooth, flowing double-Meem sound
- VISUAL CUE: The second Meem often has Shadda (■■) in the mushaf

Rule 3: Izhar Shafawi (Lip Clarity)

- TRIGGER: Meem Sakinah followed by ANY letter EXCEPT Ba (ب) or Meem (م)
- ACTION: Pronounce the Meem CLEARLY — no merging, no concealment
- This covers 26 of the 28 Arabic letters (all except ب and م)
- Example: م ت ح ذ ر ز س ش ص ض ط ظ ف ق ك غ ل ه و ي — clear Meem before Thaa (ث)
- Example: م ف — clear Meem before Fa (ف)
- Example: م غ — clear Meem before Ghayn (غ)
- Be careful not to add any nasal sound — it must be completely clear

Comparison: Meem Sakinah vs Noon Sakinah

- Both have Idgham, Ikhfa, Izhar but different letters and conditions
- Noon Sakinah: 4 rules covering all 28 letters
- Meem Sakinah: 3 rules covering all 28 letters
- Noon Sakinah Ikhfa: 15 letters | Meem Sakinah Ikhfa: only Ba (ب) (1 letter)
- Key similarity: both use Ghunnah (nasal resonance) in their Ikhfa and Idgham
- Common Mistake: forgetting Ikhfa Shafawi before Ba — saying a clear Meem instead

Quick Reference — Meem Sakinah

- Before Ba (ب) → IKHFA Shafawi: lips close lightly + hold nasal 2 beats
- Before Meem (م) → IDGHAM Shafawi: two Meems merge + hold nasal 2 beats
- Before all other 26 letters → IZHAR Shafawi: clear, clean Meem
- All 3 rules = Shafawi (lip rules) — Meem comes from the lips
- Most common situation: Izhar (26 letters trigger it)
- Practice verse: م ت ح ذ ر ز س ش ص ض ط ظ ف ق ك غ ل ه و ي — find all Meem Sakinah rules